01 · THE DROWNING SCALE · UNLOCK

- Wear the pendant ceaselessly for a full lunar cycle, answering its whispered questions honestly each night
- Hold yourself underwater until you genuinely risk drowning

Risk. Make a STR save, DC 14, or take 1 Wound. Each night's honest answer is a secret the GM may make true in the fiction.

01 · THE DROWNING SCALE · POWER

Breath ☐☐☐☐

Gain 1 Breath each time you draw a creature's last breath (see Last Breath). All Breath is lost when you take the pendant off. A rest does not clear it.

Last Breath (Reaction, 1/round): When a creature within Reach 2 drops to 0 HP, other than one you created or summoned, you draw its last breath and gain 1 Breath. Make a WIL save, DC 12, or gain a Condition of the GM's choice from Frightened, Dazed or Slowed until the end of your next turn.

Cold Skin (Passive): While you hold any Breath, you are immune to cold damage and to the dangers of extreme cold.

Hold the Breath (Free, spend 1 Breath): You go without air for up to one hour.

Choke (1 Action, spend 2 Breath): A creature within Reach 2 gasps. It makes a STR save, DC 13, or is Incapacitated as it chokes, until the end of its next turn. Solo creatures save with advantage. The whispers tell you its name.

01 · THE DROWNING SCALE · PRICE

If you use Hold the Breath or Choke with too little Breath, make a WIL save, DC 12. On a success the power fails and no Breath is spent. On a failure you inhale your own breath: take 1 Wound, drop to 0 HP and fall Dying.

02 · THE HOURGLASS OF BORROWED TIME · UNLOCK

- Watch one full night without sleeping
- Tell an NPC, truthfully, the moment you would undo

Risk. The sand climbs for a stranger first. They relive their last hour, and they remember you. Make a WIL save, DC 12, or the hour comes out of your own life: lose 1 Hit Die until your next Safe Rest.

02 · THE HOURGLASS OF BORROWED TIME · POWER

Sand ☐☐☐

Spend 1 Sand each time you Turn Back. Regain 1 by returning to the place where you last turned time back and letting the glass run for an hour. Sand returns only this way.

Turn Back (Reaction, spend 1 Sand, after a die you can see is rolled and before its result is applied): One die, yours or anyone's, from any roll, is rerolled. The new result stands.

Sand Sense (Passive): You always know the exact time, and you can tell when a clock, a calendar, or a witness near you has it wrong.

02 · THE HOURGLASS OF BORROWED TIME · PRICE

When the last Sand falls, the original result happened somewhere. Within a session an Echo of you arrives carrying its consequences, and it wants the glass. Roll a d6 on the table below, or choose.

What the Echo carries (d6): 1 a debt to the Black Hand you never took on; 2 a fresh Wound, which it hands to you at the next encounter; 3 a friend who remembers the original result, and is angry; 4 a key to an arch that should not exist; 5 news of a death that did not happen here; 6 an offer to trade places with you for one day.

03 · THE BLACK LOTUS CASE · UNLOCK

- Find someone who survived the preparation
- Fast three days
- Eat the first petal under watch

Risk. WIL DC 14 or take 2 Wounds, and the Stain advances now.

03 · THE BLACK LOTUS CASE · POWER

Petals ☐☐☐

Spend 1 Petal each time you eat one. Regain 1 by seeding the bloom where someone you knew died and tending the soil for a week. Petals return only this way.

Eat a Petal (Action, spend 1 Petal): Choose one of the three effects below. It lasts an encounter.

Smoke Step (Free, 1/round, while chosen): Teleport to a spot you can see within 6 spaces.

Wallwalker (Passive, while chosen): Climb sheer surfaces and walk on water.

Drowsing Pollen (once, when chosen): One creature of level 5 or lower within 2 spaces makes a WIL save, DC 13, or falls asleep: Incapacitated for 1d4 rounds, or until it takes damage.

03 · THE BLACK LOTUS CASE · PRICE

Each time the case empties, the Stain advances for good. 1: fingertips blacken: advantage on Finesse, and disadvantage on Might, because your grip has gone numb. 2: veins darken: +1 Initiative, and disadvantage on Stealth, because your pulse is audible. 3: eyes black: you see in the dark, sunlight stings (disadvantage on Perception in daylight), and strangers flinch (disadvantage on Influence). Stage 3 is the last Stain. After it, the bloom roots in your palm: you no longer need the case to carry the petals, and no one can take them from you.

04 · THE OATH-BAND · UNLOCK

- Swear aloud before a living witness
- The oath must be something you would not otherwise do and will take at least a full session to fulfil; the GM may refuse one that matches your plans

Risk. The Band holds your words, not your meaning. The GM may close loopholes, and when they do the oath is graded one step higher. If you then fail it, you lose the higher grade's max HP.

04 · THE OATH-BAND · POWER

Oath ☐

Set when you swear. Clears when you fulfil the oath, or when the GM rules it broken or abandoned. One oath at a time, and a new one only after the last has cleared.

Sworn (Passive): While the oath stands, you have advantage on checks that directly advance it. The GM grades it when you swear. Worthy: a session's work, at risk to you. Mighty: an arc's work, at risk to someone or something you love. Legendary: it changes the city.

Hold Fast (Reaction, once per oath): When you fail a check or save that directly advances the oath, reroll it with advantage. The oath drops one grade; a Worthy oath has no grade to drop, so fulfilling it then heals 1 Wound and gives no max HP.

04 · THE OATH-BAND · PRICE

Fulfilled: heal 1 Wound and gain +1, +2 or +3 max HP for good, by grade. The Band's total max HP bonus never exceeds your level. Failed: the oath clears, you lose that much max HP for good, the Golden Council writes the broken oath on the record under your name, and the Band stays shut until you do a penance.

05 · THE UNPAID FAVOR · UNLOCK

- Learn which of the Lower Twelve it belongs to
- Make a true offering at midnight

Risk. The patron takes a small price first. Make a WIL save, DC 12. On a success it takes only your name until the next episode: no one who meets you remembers it afterward. On a failure it takes a memory, and the GM names which.

05 · THE UNPAID FAVOR · POWER

Tithe ☐☐☐

Gain 1 Tithe each time you Call In. Tithe clears only when you do the patron a favor the GM presents.

Call In (Action, +1 Tithe): Name one small, specific impossibility, and the GM approves it before you take the Tithe. Examples: a door opens, a lie is believed, or a creature within 6 spaces is Dazed until the end of its next turn (WIL save, DC 13, negates).

Warm (Passive): The symbol grows hot when a worshipper of the Lower Twelve is within 6 spaces.

05 · THE UNPAID FAVOR · PRICE

If you Call In with 3 Tithe, the patron collects first. Roll a d6. 1 Newt: you are Tiny and Incapacitated for 3 rounds. 2 Imps: lose 2 random items. 3 Salt ring: a ring of salt closes around your space, and you cannot leave it until someone else spends an action to scatter it. 4 Cobwebs: no arcanum use until you do the favor that clears Tithe. 5 Nemesis: a stranger swears to hunt you; write them a thread card (if the board is full, tick the closest clock). 6 Wither: take 1 Wound.

06 · THE VALKYRIE'S FEATHER · UNLOCK

- Dig it from the grave
- Learn the warrior's story

Risk. 1 in 20 the valkyrie comes for the grave-robber before you finish.

06 · THE VALKYRIE'S FEATHER · POWER

Tally ☐☐☐☐☐☐

Add 1 Tally each time you use Spared, then roll a d6. If it rolls equal to or under your Tally, a valkyrie comes for the spared life (see Escalation). Tally has no maximum, so at 6 or more every Spared calls her. Tally clears only when you carry the feather back to its stone in the grave it came from.

Spared (Reaction, 1/encounter, +1 Tally): You or an ally within 6 spaces stays at 1 HP instead of dropping to 0. It takes no Wound and is not Dying.

Cold Barbs (Passive): The barbs glow when a creature within 12 spaces drops to 0 HP.

06 · THE VALKYRIE'S FEATHER · PRICE

A valkyrie arrives within a day to claim the spared life, yours or your ally's. She will hear one argument for it. The GM plays her.

07 · THE HELLHIDE · UNLOCK

- Learn which demon of Irax gave the skin, and speak its name into the helm
- Find a smith who will refit it to you, and pay their price
- Put it on

Risk. Roll d10. On 1-3 the hide drinks magic: no spell can affect you, including your own and your allies' healing, while you wear it, and each spell cast on you gives the hide 1 Thirst.

07 · THE HELLHIDE · POWER

Thirst ☐☐☐

Gain 1 Thirst each time you use Command, and, if the hide drinks magic, each time a spell is cast on you. Thirst cannot pass 3. Thirst clears only when you offer blood to the hide outside combat, from a willing person outside your party. Blood shed in a fight does not count.

Demon Plate (Passive): Plate armor, Defense 14, with no STR requirement. Without plate armor proficiency, Defend costs 1 extra action, as normal.

Terror (Passive): The first time a creature sees you in an encounter, it makes a WIL save, DC 14, or has -1 to all its rolls near you for the encounter.

Command (Action, +1 Thirst, 1/encounter): One undead or demon within 6 spaces that can hear you makes a WIL save, DC 14. On a failure, on its next turn it obeys one command of five words or fewer. It will not harm itself. Solo creatures save with advantage.

07 · THE HELLHIDE · PRICE

You cannot willingly part with the hide, and you will hunt anyone who takes it. If you end a day with 3 Thirst, it drinks from you at dawn: take 1 Wound that cannot heal while you wear it. If you die in it, you rise as a spectre.

08 · THE KETTLE PLATE · UNLOCK

- Learn at Vathrex's Forge whose measure it was built to, and why that owner never came for it
- Have it refitted to you, which costs a favor the makers name
- Stoke it yourself, the first time

Risk. The refit fails on a test fire. 1d6 fire damage and a week of repairs.

08 · THE KETTLE PLATE · POWER

Steam ☐☐☐☐

Spend 1 Steam per use. Regain all by stoking the boilers with a load of forge coal drawn from Vathrex's Forge, which means a trip to the ziggurat and whatever price Erna Ironhorn names. A load fills the boilers once and takes an inventory slot. Steam returns only this way.

Iron Joints (Passive): Plate armor, Defense 18, with no STR requirement. Without plate armor proficiency, Defend costs 1 extra action, as normal.

Boiler Fire (spend 1 Steam): Choose one. Wrist crossbow (Free, 1/turn): a ranged attack, Range 8, 1d8+DEX piercing, no loading. Hidden blade (Action): a melee attack, 1d8+STR slashing. Boiler surge (Free): advantage on one Might check.

08 · THE KETTLE PLATE · PRICE

At 0 Steam the servos lock: Speed 2 and disadvantage on DEX until stoked. If you spend the last Steam in combat, the boilers vent: 1d6 fire to you and everyone adjacent.

09 · THE FAIRY JAR · UNLOCK

- Learn the fairy's name, which it will not tell you; the fey beyond the Arch of Flowers in Briarheart Forest know it
- Promise it freedom, aloud, before a witness

Risk. Speak to it before you know its name, and it slips out and hexes you: make a WIL save, DC 12, or have disadvantage on WIL checks for a week.

09 · THE FAIRY JAR · POWER

Bargains ☐☐☐

Spend 1 Bargain per Ask. Regain 1 when you answer the question the fairy asks about its home. It asks one each time it runs dry, and the answer always lies through an arch: any trip through one can carry a clue. Bargains return only this way.

Ask (Action, spend 1 Bargain): Make an Influence check, DC 12. On a success the fairy works one small charm: a glamour, a lock undone, a minute of floating. On a failure it sulks and stays silent for 2d6 days.

Fairy Light (Passive): The jar glows when fey are within 6 spaces.

09 · THE FAIRY JAR · PRICE

On a natural 1 the fairy escapes and curses you. Once the jar is unlocked (you know its name and have promised it freedom), you may smash it: it grants +1 to one stat for good and is gone. The fairy leaves its mark, one of your eyes turns its colour for good, and it tells its court: you owe the fey one favour, and they will collect. At 0 Bargains it only bargains for its freedom.

10 · THE APOLOGY BLADE · UNLOCK

- Give it as an apology to someone you wronged
- If they freely give it back, it wakes
- Later: make peace between two who are at war, and its storm wakes

Risk. They keep it. Make an Influence check, DC 14, to win it back with a second apology. On a failure the blade is theirs until they choose to return it.

10 · THE APOLOGY BLADE · POWER

Sky ☐☐☐

Spend Sky on Gust and Storm. Regain 1 when someone accepts your apology for a real wrong you did before you took up the blade, or one you did not mean to do. Sky returns only this way.

Overcast (Passive): The clouded edge darkens when a creature within 6 spaces is angry at you over a wrong you have not apologised for.

Gust (Action, spend 1 Sky): A wind throws every creature in a Line 6 from you, in a direction you choose, back 3 spaces (Knockback 3), allies included. STR save, DC 13, negates.

Storm (Action, spend 2 Sky, once the storm wakes): For the encounter, enemies have disadvantage on ranged attacks and you cannot be pushed.

10 · THE APOLOGY BLADE · PRICE

If you wrong the one who gave it back, it is in their hands the next morning, wherever they are.

11 · THE RUNE FRAGMENT · UNLOCK

- Find a second fragment
- Carve the first rune's name into a gravestone or standing stone, and speak aloud the name of someone who died for something
- Hold the fragments together for 10 minutes and they fuse

Risk. Whoever carries another fragment feels yours wake. Holding the shards together while they grind takes a STR save, DC 13. On a failure you take 1 Wound and must hold them for another 10 minutes.

11 · THE RUNE FRAGMENT · POWER

Runes ☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐

Each fragment carries one rune, rolled on a d8 when it fuses (roll again on a rune you already have). There are eight runes; the ninth fragment carries none of its own, and fusing it wakes the stone (see Escalation). Each rune works once, then goes dark. A dark rune relights when you carve it into a gravestone or a standing stone and speak aloud the name of someone who died for something, a name not yet spoken over that rune.

Fehu (Action): An item you touch gives +1 to rolls made with it for an hour.

Algiz (Free): Advantage on saves against fear and charm for the encounter.

Raido (Free): +2 Speed for the encounter.

Uruz (Free, after the roll): +2 to a STR check.

Tiwaz (Action): Allies who hear you have advantage on their next attack.

Ansuz (Free): Speak and read any language for an hour.

Eihwaz (Reaction): Reduce one hit's damage by your level plus STR.

Sowilo (Action): Sunlight blinds every enemy within 6 spaces until your next turn. DEX save, DC 13, negates.

11 · THE RUNE FRAGMENT · PRICE

Fragments call to each other, and other holders follow the call. When the ninth fuses, its rune wakes once: change the result of one roll made this session, even one already applied, and play on from there. Then the stone falls to dust.

12 · THE BINDING LINENS · UNLOCK

- Learn the binding words from a priest of the dead
- Wrap and bury a stranger who had no one to bury them

Risk. The stranger belonged to someone, and they come asking within a session. Make an Influence check, DC 14, to explain what you did.

12 · THE BINDING LINENS · POWER

Strips ☐☐☐

Spend 1 Strip per Hold Back. Regain 1 by preparing and burying someone who has no one to do it for them. Strips return only this way.

Hold Back (Action, spend 1 Strip): Wrap a Dying creature. It stays at 0 HP but is no longer Dying: it takes no Wounds from damage, and it cannot act. When it is unwrapped, or at the next dawn, it is Dying again. If it regains HP while wrapped, the wrap ends and it acts as normal.

Myrrh (Passive): You know at a glance how long a body has been dead and whether it was ever bound.

12 · THE BINDING LINENS · PRICE

Any creature wrapped a second time comes back a little less. It forgets one thing it loved, and the GM chooses what.

13 · THE RUSTED SPEAR · UNLOCK

- Learn whom it last wounded, and find them
- Heal that old wound with the spear's own rust

Risk. They remember you and the spear. Make an Influence check, DC 14, to be forgiven. On a failure they hunt for the spear.

13 · THE RUSTED SPEAR · POWER

Rust ☐☐☐

Spend 1 Rust per Scrape. Regain 1 by leaving the spear a night in the red water of Bloodrust Depths. Rust returns only this way.

Spare (Free): When you would kill a creature with the spear (a Legendary monster's Last Stand runs first), it is left alive and Incapacitated at 0 HP instead (a hero falls Dying as normal), and its wound will not close until you choose to mend it.

Scrape (Action, spend 1 Rust): Scrape rust into a wound to heal 1 Wound on a creature you touch, yourself included, or to close a wound the spear made.

13 · THE RUSTED SPEAR · PRICE

At 0 Rust the blade is clean and bright. The next creature it hits takes a wound that never closes: a hero gains a Wound that cannot heal and loses 1 max Wound for good, and a creature bleeds out by the end of the scene. A Legendary or Solo monster does not bleed out: it loses a third of its max HP at once (not from its Last Stand).

14 · THE DERELICT HARPOON · UNLOCK

- Cut a length of strand-line from a derelict hull in Drendaan with the harpoon's own blade
- Make one throw that hauls you across a gap you could not have jumped

Risk. Whatever lived aboard the hulk feels the line cut. Make a Stealth check, DC 13, to get clear of the hulk unseen. On a failure it follows the line through the arch within a session.

14 · THE DERELICT HARPOON · POWER

Slack ☐☐☐☐☐☐

Each time you Haul, add 1 Slack. If the Haul hits, first roll a d6 against the Slack you had before adding. If you roll equal to or below it, the line snarls (see Escalation). Slack has no maximum, so at 6 or more every Haul snarls. Slack clears when you carry a length of the line back to a derelict hull in Drendaan and splice it into the strand.

Haul (Action, Range 12, +1 Slack): Make a ranged attack with the harpoon: 1d6+STR piercing, like a thrown spear. On a hit, choose one: pull yourself to the target, or pull a Medium or smaller target up to 6 spaces toward you. A pulled creature can make a STR save, DC 13; on a success it is neither pulled nor Prone, on a failure it is pulled and falls Prone.

Anchor (Free, 1/round, after a Haul that hits): Plant the line. The target cannot move more than 6 spaces from you until your next turn or until you let go (Free).

14 · THE DERELICT HARPOON · PRICE

When the d6 triggers, the line snarls around you or your target, the GM's choice. Both of you are Restrained until either of you, or anyone adjacent, spends an action to cut it. Once the line is cut you may Haul again from your next turn. The cut length keeps glowing, and whatever lived aboard the hulk follows it through the arch.

15 · THE SEEKERS' PROVENANCE LEDGER · UNLOCK

- Return a relic to its rightful owner or their heirs, and have the owner sign it into the ledger
- Give up the relic's price: you may not sell it or take payment

Risk. The Black Hand hears that someone is naming relics, and the GM starts a six-step Black Hand clock about who.

15 · THE SEEKERS' PROVENANCE LEDGER · POWER

Provenance ☐☐☐

Spend 1 Provenance per Name the Owner or Vouch. Gain 1 Provenance each time you return a relic to its rightful owner and have them sign it into the ledger. Provenance returns only this way.

Name the Owner (Action, spend 1 Provenance): Touch an object. The ledger writes its maker, its last three owners, and its rightful owner, if it has one. A lie in the record shows as an ink blot.

Vouch (Reaction, spend 1 Provenance): When an ally within 6 spaces makes an Influence check about an object or its owner, they have advantage.

Margins (Passive): The ledger shows a blot when you hold it within 6 spaces of a stolen or cursed object.

15 · THE SEEKERS' PROVENANCE LEDGER · PRICE

When the last Provenance is spent, the ledger writes one relic's name and its rightful owner on a blank page without being asked. The GM chooses the relic, and the owner is someone you know. The Seekers of the Sun and the Black Hand both learn it has been written. Roll a d6 on the table below, or choose.

The relic the ledger writes (d6): 1 something from the Vaults of the Nameless King; 2 an arcanum another hero carries; 3 a piece on display in the Museum of Worlds Beyond; 4 an heirloom of your own family; 5 a key to one of the city's arches; 6 a relic still lying in Sunken Revvia.

16 · THE BLACK GOAT'S TALLY-STICK · UNLOCK

- Drink at the Black Goat's Tavern through a full night, and settle your tab in full
- Broker a meeting there between two parties who would fight anywhere else, and keep it peaceful

Risk. If a peace you broker at the tavern breaks, you take 1 Wound, and Vynan Halfhorn wants the one who broke it.

16 · THE BLACK GOAT'S TALLY-STICK · POWER

Truce ☐

Strike the stick on a table to call a Truce, which turns it on. It turns off when the parley ends, when you end it, or when anyone attempts violence under it. Once off, it cannot be turned on again until you have brokered a meeting between two enemies who would not otherwise have met, and settled the tab for it at the Black Goat's Tavern.

Call a Truce (Action, turn Truce on): Name a place and up to six people in it. For an hour, or until the parley ends, a named creature that tries to attack or harm another named creature makes a WIL save, DC 14. On a failure the attack does not happen, and the action is spent. Either way, the Truce ends. Violence by anyone not named ends it at once, with no save, and the stick burns you as below.

Read the Notches (Passive): When you hold the stick at a table, you know who in the room owes whom, and whether the debt is money, a favor, or blood.

16 · THE BLACK GOAT'S TALLY-STICK · PRICE

If the Truce breaks, the stick burns your palm for 1 Wound, and Vynan Halfhorn sends someone for whoever broke it within a session. Vynan Halfhorn will want to know why the peace failed under his stick.

17 · THE GATE CHAIN · UNLOCK

- Hold a doorway, gate or bridge alone for three rounds while others get away
- Carry someone who could not get out alone to safety

Risk. While you hold the doorway, make a STR save, DC 13, at the end of each round. Each failure is 1 Wound.

17 · THE GATE CHAIN · POWER

Ward ☐☐☐

Regain 1 when you carry or lead someone who cannot get out alone to safety, out of a place where they would have died. Ward returns only this way.

Draw Fire (Action, spend 1 Ward): Rattle the chain. Each enemy within 6 spaces that can see you makes a WIL save, DC 13, or is Taunted by you until the end of its next turn. Solo creatures save with advantage.

Long Links (Passive): Your Interpose reaches allies within 4 spaces, not 2.

Hold the Line (Free, spend 1 Ward, when you Interpose): You also Defend against that attack without spending an action for it. This counts as your Defend for the round.

17 · THE GATE CHAIN · PRICE

When you spend the last Ward, the chain locks: until the encounter ends, you cannot willingly move away from an enemy. The Wardens' Lodge hears the old gate chain rang again. They want it back on the gate, and their gate captain drinks where the wall guards drink.

18 · THE SOWN TEETH · UNLOCK

- Read the command words etched inside the flap, in a dead language
- Sow the first tooth on ground you mean to hold

Risk. The first warrior asks whom it must guard. Your answer binds every warrior after it, and the GM holds you to the letter.

18 · THE SOWN TEETH · POWER

Teeth ☐☐☐☐☐☐

Each Sow uses up one tooth. A sown tooth never comes back, and nothing refills the satchel.

Sow (Action, spend 1 Tooth): An armored warrior (Medium, Speed 6; the armor is for show) rises from the ground beside you and obeys you for an hour. It fights as a minion (GM guide): it attacks with a d10 (d12 from level 5, d20 from level 9), any damage destroys it, and all your warriors move and attack together on your turn.

Dragon's Click (Passive): The teeth click louder within 6 spaces of a dragon or dragonkin.

18 · THE SOWN TEETH · PRICE

If two or more warriors stand and one is hit by an attacker it could not see, they turn on each other, then on whoever is closest. Dragons and their kin can smell the satchel. When the last tooth is gone, the satchel is just a bag.

19 · THE HUT ON HEN'S LEGS · UNLOCK

- Find the hut and say: "Hut, hut, turn your back to the forest and your face to me."
- Feed it a meal it has never eaten, brought from beyond the city
- Sleep one night inside

Risk. Before you sleep, the hut asks a riddle. Make a Lore check, DC 14. On a failure it turns its back and walks off, and you must find it again.

19 · THE HUT ON HEN'S LEGS · POWER

Hunger ☐☐☐

Regain 1 each time you feed it a food it has never eaten, brought from a world beyond an arch or a region outside the city. Hunger returns only this way.

Home (Passive): The hut is a holding wherever it stands: a Safe Rest place for you and up to five guests. It will not fit down a street narrower than a wagon.

Run (spend 1 Hunger): The hut carries everyone inside at a run: a day's overland travel in an hour.

Stamp (Action, spend 1 Hunger, while you are inside or adjacent): Each creature within 2 spaces of the hut makes a DEX save, DC 13, or takes 2d6 bludgeoning and falls Prone.

19 · THE HUT ON HEN'S LEGS · PRICE

If no one sleeps in the hut for a whole episode, it walks off toward the nearest arch, and you must find it again. The Sisters of Dusk know whose hut it was, and they want to know why a stranger holds her key.

20 · THE CRAFTER'S CODEX · UNLOCK

- Make something with your own hands from its pages, and give it away
- Find the last owner's apprentice and let them read what you added

Risk. The apprentice judges your work. Make a Finesse check, DC 13. On a failure they tell the Forge where the book is.

20 · THE CRAFTER'S CODEX · POWER

Patience ☐☐☐

Regain 1 when you teach someone a craft from its pages through a full day of downtime. Patience returns only this way.

Consult (downtime, 1 hour): Make a Lore check, DC 13. On a success, your next Craft downtime takes half the time and half the materials. On a failure, spend 1 Patience.

Patch (Action, spend 1 Patience): A broken weapon, shield, armor or arcanum object you touch works again until the encounter ends, or for an hour outside one. Patch restores function only, never spent resources, and cannot mend what an arcanum's Escalation broke.

Maker's Price (Passive): Things you make from the Codex sell for double, and buyers know the hand.

20 · THE CRAFTER'S CODEX · PRICE

At 0 Patience the Codex moves on: by morning it is gone, to a copy of itself in another world. Whoever you taught can still find it. The Forge's smiths come to your door asking what you did with it.

21 · THE HEXING NEEDLES · UNLOCK

- Learn the stitch from a witch, at her price
- Embroider your own likeness first

Risk. Your first stitch slips. You carry a small hex of your own making, and have disadvantage on one kind of roll, the GM's choice, until you unpick it.

21 · THE HEXING NEEDLES · POWER

Thread ☐☐☐

Spend 1 Thread per Stitch. Regain 1 when someone outside your party gives you their hair, blood, or cloth freely, knowing what it is for. Thread returns only this way. Unpicking a hex frees its victim but gives back no Thread.

Stitch (an hour of work, spend 1 Thread): Embroider a likeness of someone, using their hair, blood, or cloth. They have disadvantage on one kind of roll you name until the cloth is unpicked or burned. They feel every stitch.

Thread Sense (Passive): You can tell when cloth you touch carries a stitched hex, and whose likeness it is.

21 · THE HEXING NEEDLES · PRICE

Every victim knows the shape of your hands, and the Sisters of Dusk hear who is stitching in their style. At 0 Thread you can still Stitch, but the hex also lands on you, in your body, not on cloth: it lasts until you regain Thread, and unpicking cannot touch it.

22 · THE BEAR-LODGE HORN · UNLOCK

- Go through the arch and find the lodge it was taken from
- Bring the lodge a hunt: a beast its hunters could not take
- Blow it once in their hall, with their leave

Risk. The lodge tests you first. Make a Might check, DC 14, in their contest of strength. On a failure they keep the horn until you bring a second hunt.

22 · THE BEAR-LODGE HORN · POWER

Call ☐☐☐

Regain all Call when you carry the horn back to the lodge hall and tell them the hunt you used it for. Call returns only this way.

Hunting Call (Action, spend 1 Call): Every ally within 12 spaces who hears it gains +2 Speed and advantage on their next attack, until the end of their next turn.

The Horde (Action, spend 2 Call): Three spirit bears rise within 6 spaces and fight as minions (GM guide), Medium, Speed 6, until the encounter ends. Each attacks with a d10 (d12 from level 5, d20 from level 9), any damage destroys one, and they move and attack together on your turn. An enemy that starts its turn adjacent to a bear is Slowed.

Lodge-Kin (Passive): Beasts of cold lands do not attack you unless you attack first.

22 · THE BEAR-LODGE HORN · PRICE

If the horn leaves your hands without the lodge's leave, the bears hunt whoever carries it: each dawn, 1d4 great bears of the ice world find the carrier. If you blow it for a hunt the lodge would be ashamed of, its speaker comes through the arch to take it back. Name the speaker at the table.

23 · THE AXE OF NINE EYES · UNLOCK

- Learn what the axe was called before it was named, from Archkeeper records or something older than the Golden Order
- Let it name a creature in a room you thought was empty
- Hold the line against that creature until it flees or dies

Risk. The creature's side now knows your name, and the GM starts a six-step clock for them.

23 · THE AXE OF NINE EYES · POWER

Eyes ☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐

Each Name It closes one eye. A closed eye never reopens, and nothing refills the axe.

Name It (Action, spend 1 Eye): Choose one creature you can see. You learn its True Name and have advantage on skill checks against it.

Named (Passive): You always know the direction and distance of any creature you have Named.

Speak the Name (Reaction, 1/encounter, when a Named creature you can see starts its turn): It is Dazed this turn. WIL DC 14 negates; Solo creatures save with advantage.

23 · THE AXE OF NINE EYES · PRICE

Named creatures learn your name and heading each dawn. When the ninth eye closes, the axe speaks your True Name and all nine hear it. One engraved eye is scraped blank.

24 · THE ARCH-WATCH MIRROR · UNLOCK

- Install it in your holding or your guild hall (the guild will want to look too)
- For each arch it should watch, carry a sliver of its glass through that arch and back, unbroken

Risk. Each sliver must come back unbroken. Carrying one through an arch and back takes a Finesse check, DC 12. A broken sliver lets whatever is on that side look back through the mirror until a night's vigil clears it.

24 · THE ARCH-WATCH MIRROR · POWER

Clarity ☐☐☐

Spend 1 Clarity for Watch or Foresee. Regain all after someone keeps a full night's vigil before the mirror without sleeping. Clarity returns only this way.

Shimmer (Passive): The mirror shimmers whenever a watched arch is used.

Watch (10 minutes, spend 1 Clarity): See a watched arch and the area around it for 10 minutes.

Foresee (spend 1 Clarity, once per episode): Before you go through, ask the GM one question about where the arch leads.

24 · THE ARCH-WATCH MIRROR · PRICE

At 0 Clarity the glass stays clear both ways. Anything beyond a watched arch can see and hear the room the mirror stands in until the mirror is refilled. Covering the glass does not stop it.

25 · THE FORGOTTEN KEY · UNLOCK

- Present it to every arch in the Market Square while the Archkeepers watch
- Find the one arch that hums
- Spend a full night at its threshold

Risk. The arch opens briefly. Hold it with a Might check, DC 13, or something comes through before you close the way. Closing it then takes a Lore check, DC 12.

25 · THE FORGOTTEN KEY · POWER

Hum ☐☐☐

Spend 1 Hum each time you Open the Way. Regain 1 when you carry the key, during a gig, to an arch you have not yet tried it on and an Archkeeper records what the arch did. This is never an off-screen refill. Hum never returns at a rest.

Open the Way (Action, spend 1 Hum): A dormant arch opens for up to a minute. This key is old and wrong, unlike a true arch key: make a Lore check, DC 12, or you cannot control where it leads. A natural 20 lets you sense the destination first.

Tuning (Passive): The key hums faintly within 6 spaces of a dormant arch.

25 · THE FORGOTTEN KEY · PRICE

Spending the last Hum, roll a d6. On 1-2 the key splinters, and every arch it opens leads somewhere wrong until an Archkeeper repairs it. On 3+, take 1 Wound.

26 · THE PITCH-SAP HARNESS · UNLOCK

- Find an old tree in the Lost Cavern of the Sundering Saurians willing to give its sap
- Wear it through one fight without taking it off

Risk. The sap takes. It won't come off until the next full moon.

26 · THE PITCH-SAP HARNESS · POWER

Burden ☐☐☐

Burden (pip tracker, max 3), one per weapon currently stuck in the sap. Prying a stuck weapon loose removes its Burden. A sealed or half-Defense harness is glued again only with fresh sap from the tree that gave it. A Safe Rest does not clear Burden.

Thorned Bark (Passive): Mail armor, Defense 6+DEX (max 2) and advantage on Stealth in forests and jungles. Each Burden gives -1 Speed. Without mail armor proficiency, Defend costs 1 extra action, as normal.

Snare (Reaction, +1 Burden): When a melee weapon hits you, the attacker makes a STR save, DC 13, or the weapon sticks. The attacker must let go of it or stay adjacent to you; anyone can pry a stuck weapon free with an action and a Might check, DC 13. A creature using natural weapons is Grappled to you, escaping as from any grapple, and adds no Burden.

26 · THE PITCH-SAP HARNESS · PRICE

When a fourth weapon would stick, it sticks, Burden stays at 3, and the sap seals you in: you are Restrained until someone spends an action and passes a Might check, DC 14, to cut you out. Then the harness gives half its Defense until it is glued again with fresh sap.

27 · THE SEVEN-LEAF BRACELET · UNLOCK

- Wear it through a night in old woods
- Answer the first question the trees ask you, truthfully

Risk. The trees ask about something you would rather they never knew. Answer truthfully, or the bracelet will not wake until you do. Whatever you answer, every plant in the grove now knows it.

27 · THE SEVEN-LEAF BRACELET · POWER

Leaves ☐☐☐☐☐☐☐

Each Listen wilts one leaf. A wilted leaf never comes back, and nothing refills the bracelet.

Listen (Action, spend 1 Leaf): Speak with the plants around you for 10 minutes, or speak Elvish for a day. Plants tell you who passed and may move aside or tangle.

Rustle (Passive): The leaves stir when a creature hiding in or behind plants is within 6 spaces.

27 · THE SEVEN-LEAF BRACELET · PRICE

When the last leaf wilts the bracelet buds. Plant it beside a door to elsewhere within a month, and in a year a new bracelet grows there. If you don't plant it, your fingertips start to leaf.

28 · THE TIDE-COAT · UNLOCK

- Win it from the Revlenders of Heron's Stride or the people of a drowned place, or earn it in their service
- Wear it for a full night underwater

Risk. Something in the deep hears the hum. Make a Stealth check, DC 12, on the way up, with the coat's usual Stealth penalty. On a failure it follows you up and arrives within a session.

28 · THE TIDE-COAT · POWER

Growth ☐☐☐☐

Gain 1 Growth for each hour you spend underwater in a drowned place (the Lost Cisterns, Sunken Revvia, a flooded vault), beyond what the gig needs. That hour costs a scene. A rest never adds Growth. Lose 1 Growth when you take a Wound, and 1 for each episode in which you never go underwater. Using Eel Slip spends 1 Growth.

Tide Skin (Passive): You can breathe water while you wear it. Leather armor, Defense 3+DEX, plus 1 per Growth. Each Growth also gives -1 to Stealth. Without leather armor proficiency, Defend costs 1 extra action, as normal.

Eel Slip (Reaction, spend 1 Growth): When you are Grappled or Restrained, you slip free and move 1 space.

28 · THE TIDE-COAT · PRICE

At 4 Growth the coat is a landmark, and things in the deep start coming to see it.

29 · MUD FROM THE REVLEND MARSHES · UNLOCK

- Spend a full night alone in the Revlend Marshes, or in the Deadlands adjacent to them, without shelter or fire.
- Something in the marshes must acknowledge you before dawn. You will know if it did.

Risk. At dawn, make a WIL save, DC 13. On a failure, the marshes keep something small from you (the GM names it: your first name, the color of your eyes, the sound of your laugh) until you carry the jar back and refill it.

29 · MUD FROM THE REVLEND MARSHES · POWER

Earthpulse ☐☐☐☐

The jar holds 4 Earthpulse when it is full. Using the mud spends Earthpulse (see Powers). Spent Earthpulse returns only when you carry the jar back to the Revlend Marshes and leave it there overnight. A rest does not refill it.

Apply (1 Action, spend 1 Earthpulse): Smear the mud on yourself or a willing creature. While it is applied, the creature cannot be pushed, thrown, or moved by non-magical forced movement. Mud washes off in rain or after a Field Rest.

Extend the Beastshift (Free, spend 2 Earthpulse, once per Beastshift): Until the end of this encounter, casting spells does not end your Beastshift. It still ends at 0 HP or when you end it.

Mire (1 Action, spend all 4): Create a 3-space radius of difficult terrain centered on you that lasts until the end of the encounter. The ground thickens and pulls. Any creature that starts its turn in the mire is Slowed.

29 · MUD FROM THE REVLEND MARSHES · PRICE

When the jar is empty, mud already applied does not dry, but no new mud can be applied until the jar is refilled. If the jar breaks, the mud it held dries at once and all its effects end. A skilled craftsperson can repair a broken jar, but the marshes must still refill it. Each time you return to refill it, the marshes have changed, and the GM says how. Roll a d6 on the table below, or choose.

How the marshes have changed (d6): 1 the water has risen, and Heron's Stride stands on its last stilts; 2 a path of stones now leads to where you slept; 3 the GM reveals one step of the Revlend Marshes' Neglect clock; 4 something has left a gift where you leave the jar; 5 the mud smells of a different storm: the next refill takes two nights; 6 Revlenders ask you to carry a message back to the city.

30 · THE ANCESTOR'S KNUCKLEBONE · UNLOCK

- Defeat an enemy in single combat without any ally's assistance: no ally attacks it, heals you, or gives either of you a condition or advantage.
- Keep one of the body's hand bones.
- Spend a night alone with it before you sleep, and see how the ancestor fought.

Risk. At dawn, make a WIL save, DC 12. On a failure, the ancestor's last fight plays out in you: take 1 Wound you do not remember taking, and whatever hunted them learns where you sleep.

30 · THE ANCESTOR'S KNUCKLEBONE · POWER

Fury Echo ☐☐☐

Gain 1 Fury Echo each time you tell a listener who has not heard it how the ancestor fought and fell, in full, over at least ten minutes. Echo never clears at a rest or when combat ends. Spent Echo returns only by telling it again to a new listener.

Echo Strike (Free, while Raging, spend 1 Fury Echo): Roll a Fury Die and set it aside with the rest, up to your maximum. This does not use your Rage action. The die follows the Fury Die rules and is lost when your Rage ends.

Death's Door (Free, 1/encounter, when you Rage, spend all 3 Fury Echo): For this encounter, your Rage does not end when you drop to 0 HP. Your Fury Dice stay. You are still Dying, with all its rules, and Enduring Rage still applies once you have it. This is the bone's last act (see Escalation).

30 · THE ANCESTOR'S KNUCKLEBONE · PRICE

If you drop to 0 HP with Death's Door active, the knucklebone cracks at once and stops working. Your Rage still holds for the encounter. Replace it with another ancestor's relic from the Borderlands, or take one from a worthy enemy. The GM decides where it is and how long the search takes. Whatever hunted the ancestor learns the bone has moved. Roll a d6 on the table below, or choose.

Where the replacement relic is (d6): 1 Sevelet's Throne, among the warring souls (Doorish Hills); 2 the Watchtower of Averost, on a Blood Spear's skeletal veteran (Doorish Hills); 3 under the offerings at the Cairn of the Last Titan (Doorish Hills); 4 the Red Sand's Bout Rolls name a fighter buried with one; 5 Mirewraith's Barrow, with the Eternal Blades (Revlend Marshes); 6 on the next enemy who nearly beats you.

31 · THE BATTLE STANDARD OF THE NAMELESS KING · UNLOCK

- Lead a group of at least five non-party combatants to victory: soldiers, militia, hired swords, anyone you commanded in the field. The victory must be real, a fight that could have been lost.
- Plant the standard yourself, in plain sight of the enemy.

Risk. The first time you plant it, roll a d6. On a 1-3, someone in the watching crowd or the enemy ranks recognizes the standard, and the Knights of the Nameless King send an agent within two sessions.

31 · THE BATTLE STANDARD OF THE NAMELESS KING · POWER

Authority ☐☐☐

Gain 1 Authority whenever an ally within 4 spaces of the planted standard deals damage in a single attack equal to or greater than your level, at most 1 Authority per attack. Authority is strictly encounter-bound: all unspent pips are lost when combat ends, regardless of how many are held. It cannot be saved or stockpiled between encounters.

Plant it (1 Action): Drive the standard into the ground within Reach 1. While it stands, allies within 4 spaces who can see it have advantage on their first attack each round. Spend 1 Authority to extend the aura by 2 spaces until your next turn.

Pull it (Free): The standard returns to your hand and the aura ends immediately.

Hold Ground (Reaction, spend 2 Authority): When the standard would be knocked over, stolen, or destroyed, it refuses. It cannot be moved by any force until the start of your next turn.

31 · THE BATTLE STANDARD OF THE NAMELESS KING · PRICE

When you plant the standard a second time in one encounter, after it was pulled or knocked over, while Authority is at 0, the insignia becomes briefly legible to everyone present. The GM reads what it says aloud. It goes dark again immediately. What it says is the GM's tool: a name, a title, a command. Roll a d6 on the table below, or choose.

What the insignia says (d6): 1 a name, and a Knight of the Nameless King in the crowd answers to it; 2 a title: the captain of a company that died here; 3 a command: "Hold until I return"; 4 a place: Sevelet's Throne; 5 a date: the next Final Rest of the Nameless King; 6 your own name.

32 · THE BELL OF THE THREE SISTERS · UNLOCK

- Heal a creature you expected, and had good reason, to be your enemy, spending healing that an ally needed.
- The expectation must be genuine. The bell listens.

Risk. The first time you ring it at the Temple of the Three Sisters, the clergy ask who consecrated it. Make an Influence check, DC 14, to answer without lying. On a failure they take the bell for study until you run an errand for them.

32 · THE BELL OF THE THREE SISTERS · POWER

Resonance ☐☐☐☐

Gain 1 Resonance by ringing the bell for an hour over a sickbed or a grave, at the Temple of the Three Sisters or among the tombs of the Cliffs of the Dead, and staying with whoever it is for until the hour ends. Resonance does not clear at a rest. Spent Resonance returns only this way.

Ring Out (Free, spend 1 Resonance): One Dying ally within 6 spaces hears the bell. On its next turn it acts as if it were not Dying: no 1-action limit, and no STR save to attack. It is still Dying, and still takes Wounds from damage.

Chain Heal (Reaction, spend 2 Resonance): When your Lifebinding Spirit heals a creature to maximum HP, the excess healing carries to the nearest damaged ally within 4 spaces. The chain triggers once per Reaction.

Toll (1 Action, spend all 4): Ring the bell loudly. All Dying allies within 6 spaces gain 1 HP and are no longer Dying. You take 1 Wound.

32 · THE BELL OF THE THREE SISTERS · PRICE

Spending all 4 Resonance in the Toll cracks the bell's handle. It still rings, but you cannot Toll until a clergyperson of the Three Sisters rehandles it. They will want to know what happened before they agree to help.

33 · THE BORDERLANDS TRACKING CORD · UNLOCK

- Track a single creature across at least two sessions without losing the trail, through city, ruin, or wilderness. The creature must be aware it is being hunted, and must have tried to lose you at least once.

Risk. Each session you track the creature, the GM rolls a d6. On a 1, it doubles back and ambushes you, and it acts first in the next encounter.

33 · THE BORDERLANDS TRACKING CORD · POWER

Marks ☐☐☐☐☐☐

Your Mark count is the number of quarries the cord currently tracks. Each quarry takes one token, so the cord tracks no more quarries than it has unburned tokens (six to begin with). Roll 1d6 each time you use a cord ability (Mark a Quarry or Cord Pull), before any new Mark is added. If you roll equal to or below your current Mark count, something near the quarry you are marking or pulling noticed you. A Mark clears when you confront that quarry directly (you end a turn adjacent to it, and it is aware of you), and its token is free for a new quarry; or when you Cut its Mark, and its token burns. Resting does not clear Marks.

Mark a Quarry (1 Action): Touch the cord to any physical trace of a creature: a footprint, a drop of blood, shed skin. Add 1 Mark. While that quarry is marked, you know its general direction and distance within 1 mile regardless of cover or concealment. This works on creatures you have not marked with Hunter's Mark, because the cord marks independently of the class ability.

Cord Pull (Free, 1/encounter): When your marked quarry moves away from you, pull the cord taut. The quarry is Slowed (Speed halved on its next turn). The quarry makes no save, but the cord's d6 still applies. The quarry feels it.

Cut the Mark (Free): Remove one Mark from the cord and burn its token. The cord forgets that quarry, your sense of its direction ends, and it is no longer tracked. Use this when the pursuit is no longer worth the rising risk. Nothing alerts the quarry.

33 · THE BORDERLANDS TRACKING CORD · PRICE

When the d6 roll triggers, the quarry, or something near it, begins tracking you in return. The GM introduces this threat within 1 to 2 sessions. The threat is proportional to what you marked: a city rat sends a rat, a Borderlands warlord sends soldiers.

34 · THE BROKEN VERDICT · UNLOCK

- Refuse to deliver a verdict you believe is just, because doing so would protect someone you love.
- The refusal must be genuine. The Verdict will know if you were simply afraid.

Risk. The GM starts a six-step clock for whoever was owed the verdict. It ticks whenever you are seen shielding the person you chose, and when it fills they act against you both.

34 · THE BROKEN VERDICT · POWER

Held Judgment ☐

When your Radiant Judgment would roll Judgment Dice, you may roll them and put them on the scales instead, which turns the toggle on. The scales hold one set of dice at a time, and while they hold it you roll no new Judgment Dice. Held dice stay on the scales past the end of the encounter. The toggle clears when you Release the dice on an attack. If the dice have fused to your Lay on Hands pool (see Escalation), only bringing the scales to the Temple of the Three Sisters clears the fusion.

Hold Judgment (Free, when Judgment Dice would be rolled): Keep the dice on the scales. While they are held, you see the remaining pan tilt when a creature within 6 spaces lies to you, visible only to you. You know. They do not know you know. You must decide what to do with that.

Release (Free, 1/encounter, on a Reach attack): Expend the held dice as Radiant Judgment normally does. This attack's radiant damage ignores armor.

34 · THE BROKEN VERDICT · PRICE

If the scales hold dice through a full Safe Rest, they fuse with your Lay on Hands pool. You cannot spend from the pool until the scales are cleared at the Temple of the Three Sisters: you perform a Sacred Decree there or, if you know none yet, a priest there absolves you. The temple will want to know why.

35 · THE CRACKED LENS OF KARTAN · UNLOCK

- Pay the pawn shop's price, which is more than the lens is worth.
- Spend a week of downtime studying the crack through the lens, and make an Arcana check, DC 12, to read the maker's mark. On a failure the week is spent and you start over.
- Then cast a spell of the highest tier you can cast, with the lens held to your eye for the whole cast.

Risk. When the cast ends, the crack pulls at your eye. Make an INT save, DC 13. On a failure the lens fails as its Escalation describes: take 1 Wound, the lens fuses to your face for an hour, and Kartan is told. If you flinch or remove the lens, the crack spreads and it is ruined.

35 · THE CRACKED LENS OF KARTAN · POWER

Overcharge ☐☐☐☐☐☐

Roll 1d6 each time you cast a tiered spell while wearing the lens, before the spell resolves. The spell takes effect either way. If you roll equal to or below your current Overcharge, the lens fails after the spell (see Escalation). On a safe roll, add 1 Overcharge once (the +1 printed on each power is that same point, not extra), and apply the one safe-roll power that fits you to this spell: Steady Glass before you choose a subclass, then Controlled Upcast or Chaos Bloom. Overcharge clears when you hold the lens to the glass of the Observatory of Infinite Skies through one night.

Controlled Upcast (on a safe roll, +1 Overcharge, Control subclass): The spell gains one Upcast for free.

Chaos Bloom (on a safe roll, +1 Overcharge, Chaos subclass): If you Invoke Chaos with this spell, roll on the Chaos Table with advantage.

Steady Glass (on a safe roll, +1 Overcharge, before you choose a subclass): The spell rolls one extra damage die.

Chaos Sight (Passive, while worn): You see magical auras on creatures and objects within 4 spaces without casting a spell. Illusions appear slightly wrong. Invisible creatures show as a faint shimmer.

35 · THE CRACKED LENS OF KARTAN · PRICE

When the d6 triggers, the glass heats to burning. Control Mage: you Lose Control, doing every option on the Control Table, with the GM choosing each time. Chaos Mage: you Invoke Chaos with disadvantage. No subclass yet: you are Dazed until the end of your next turn. Either way you take 1 Wound and cannot remove the lens until the encounter ends, because it has fused to your face. While fused it is inert: no more Overcharge rolls and no safe-roll powers. After the encounter, the Mages of Kartan sense the discharge and know its rough location. They send someone within 1 to 3 sessions. The fusing is now, the visitors are later.

36 · THE HOLLOW CONTRACT · UNLOCK

- Patron path: commune with your patron during a Safe Rest and ask it for something you know it does not want to give. Accept its counter-demand before you know what it is.
- Reaver path: you have no patron to ask. Read the vellum by your own shadow, in the room where it was found, for three nights, until the language stops changing.

Risk. Patron path: the counter-demand is whatever the GM names, and you have already agreed to it. Reaver path: make a WIL save, DC 12, each night, and each failure starts you with 1 Debt before you have any power. Either way, your patron, or the patron you left, learns the contract has a new reader.

36 · THE HOLLOW CONTRACT · POWER

Debt ☐☐☐☐

Mark Debt each time you use one of the contract's powers, as each power says. Debt above 4 is lost. Debt clears when the patron collects (see Escalation), or when you carry out a sentence you wrote in the contract: write one sentence in your own blood describing something you will do for the patron, then do it. You must write something real, and you must mean it.

Read the Contract (Free, 1/encounter, mark 1 Debt): Hold the vellum up. You see one true fact about a creature you can see: its most urgent want, its deepest fear, or the name of someone it has wronged.

Patron's Margin (Free, 1/encounter, mark 2 Debt, patron path; every Shadowmancer is on it until choosing a subclass at level 3): You need a use of Pilfered Power (gained at level 2). Spend it to cast a spell from your schools one tier above your current maximum, paying its normal action cost. The patron extends credit.

Reaver's Margin (Free, 1/encounter, mark 2 Debt, Reaver path): Your next Bonescythe strike this turn rolls one extra d12.

36 · THE HOLLOW CONTRACT · PRICE

When Debt reaches 4 or more, the patron collects. It does not take power. It adds one sentence about your character to the contract, permanently. The GM decides what it says and reads it aloud. Debt clears. The sentence stays. A Reaver's contract still answers to the patron they left: that patron writes the sentence, and sends an agent to read it to them in person. Roll a d6 on the table below, or choose.

The sentence the patron writes (d6): 1 They will refuse help once, when it matters most.; 2 They owe me the name of someone they love.; 3 They will open a door they were told to leave shut.; 4 Their shadow answers to me first.; 5 They will come back to the sealed room.; 6 They will keep one promise I choose, whatever it costs..

37 · THE LOADED DIE · UNLOCK

- Win a wager against someone who genuinely believed they had the advantage: not a mark, not a fool, but someone who should have won.
- Stake something you cannot afford to lose.

Risk. After the wager, the loser makes an Insight check against your Influence check. If they win, they know the die was loaded, and they name you to the Black Hand card sharp.

37 · THE LOADED DIE · POWER

Fixes ☐☐☐☐

Fixes do not refill automatically. To refill: run a game of chance during a Safe Rest and earn at least 1 silver in genuine winnings against an opponent who had a real chance of winning. Gain all 4 Fixes back. Safe Rests where you do not gamble leave the tracker as it is. Fixes return only this way.

Fix (Free, before you roll an attack, spend 1 Fix): Declare you are using the die. Roll your Primary Die twice and take whichever result you prefer. This replaces your Primary Die only; advantage, disadvantage and extra dice from rushing are rolled normally. No memory required, both rolls happen now, in front of everyone.

Loaded Odds (Passive): Once per session, you may ask the GM whether a creature you can see is bluffing. The die rolls and the GM answers truthfully, but only yes or no.

37 · THE LOADED DIE · PRICE

When all 4 Fixes are spent, the die gets you anyway. On your next Vicious Opportunist use after depletion, the GM secretly rolls a d6. On a 1-3 the die turns on you: Vicious Opportunist does nothing, and that use is spent, and you do not know until after you have committed. The uncertainty lasts for one use only. Word that a loaded die is back in play reaches the card sharp within a session.

38 · THE PAIN TEACHER'S WRAPPINGS · UNLOCK

- Study the wrappings' first annotation for a week of downtime.
- Then take a hit in combat that you could have Defended but deliberately chose not to, in order to observe how the attack was made. The choice must be your own. The wrappings can tell the difference between courage and negligence.

Risk. If the hit drops you to 0 HP, the wrappings do not count it. You take the Wound and must try again after you recover. The last teacher's notes stop mid-technique, and whoever silenced them hears the wrappings are in use.

38 · THE PAIN TEACHER'S WRAPPINGS · POWER

Each annotation you use costs 1 Wound. There is no tracker, only the Wounds. A Medical Kit, healing magic and other effects cannot remove these Wounds; they heal only by Safe Rest, 1 per rest. Mark them apart on your Wound track. You cannot use an annotation at 5 Wounds, because the cost would be your sixth.

Study the Form (Free, spend 1 Wound, 1/encounter): Before you attack a creature, spend 1 Wound to activate the wrappings' oldest annotations. For the rest of the encounter, your attacks against that creature ignore its armor. You are choosing to hurt yourself to learn faster.

Deepest Annotation (Free, spend 1 Wound, 1/Safe Rest): Your unarmed and melee weapon attacks deal bonus damage equal to your level for the rest of the encounter.

Study (downtime, 1 hour per Safe Rest): Spend an hour reading the annotations during rest. Roll Lore DC 8 to learn something about a martial tradition relevant to the current adventure arc. The GM provides one true detail.

38 · THE PAIN TEACHER'S WRAPPINGS · PRICE

If you use either annotation while you have 3 or more Wounds, from any source, the wrappings tighten around your hands: the annotation still works, then take 1 additional Wound (it cannot be your sixth: at 5 Wounds you drop to 0 HP and fall Dying instead) and you cannot use either annotation until your next Safe Rest. The annotations become illegible until a skilled martial artist re-inks them. Finding one is the GM's hook.

39 · THE THEATER OF WHISPERS SETLIST · UNLOCK

- Perform at the Theater of Whispers, or any venue with an audience of 20 or more, and hold the crowd's full attention for an uninterrupted hour. No skill check. Just perform.
- Find someone who heard the setlist's owner perform, and learn the last song, which has no title.

Risk. Someone in that crowd knows the hand that wrote the setlist. Make a Perception check, DC 13, to spot them before they leave. On a failure they find you first, within a session.

39 · THE THEATER OF WHISPERS SETLIST · POWER

Crowd ☐☐☐☐

Each time you Call the Song in combat, roll 1d6 against your current Crowd, then add 1 Crowd. If you roll equal to or below your Crowd before adding, someone recognises the song and has feelings about it: you have disadvantage on your next social roll with a stranger this session. Crowd cannot pass 4; at 4 you cannot Call the Song until it clears. Crowd clears when you play a full uninterrupted hour for a new audience of 20 or more.

Call the Song (Free, in combat, 1/round): Name the song you are playing and roll against your Crowd. The first safe roll each encounter returns 1 spent use of Songweaver's Inspiration.

Protective Verse (Free, 1/encounter, counts as a Call in every way: combat only, 1/round, roll against your Crowd then add 1; a first safe roll still returns Inspiration): A specific song from the setlist grants immunity to the Taunted or Frightened condition to all allies within 6 spaces until the end of the round.

39 · THE THEATER OF WHISPERS SETLIST · PRICE

When Crowd reaches 4, someone in the crowd knows who this setlist belonged to. They approach between encounters, or send someone. The GM decides who and what they want. They may be a fan. They may not. Roll a d6 on the table below, or choose.

Who knows the setlist (d6): 1 the missing Songweaver's apprentice, who wants it back; 2 a creditor the missing Songweaver owed; 3 a Whisperer, selling the story to Roselyn Zeshe; 4 a devoted fan who wants you to finish the set; 5 the thief who stole it last month; 6 the missing Songweaver, in disguise.